

The Mobile App Project Canvas (ver. 1.0)

Connecting the Last Mile — Internet for All Territorians

CONCEPT

A hybrid solution addressing the Northern Territory's digital divide by:

- Developing an offline-first learning app to give remote students access to educational resources without continuous internet.
- Deploying community-based mesh networks to provide affordable, reliable internet coverage in underserved areas.



OBJECTIVES & PURPOSES

- Reduce the digital access gap in pilot communities by at least 30% within the first year.
- Improve student access to curriculum content and telehealth services.
- Create a scalable model for other rural/remote regions.



VALUES

- Accessibility – Inclusive design for all users, regardless of connectivity.
- Affordability – Shared infrastructure lowers costs for individuals.
- Community Empowerment – Locally managed and maintained networks



PERSONAS



- Remote Students** – Children and young adults in rural and Indigenous communities without stable internet access.
- Teachers & Educators** – Upload and distribute learning materials that students can use offline.
- Healthcare Workers** – Deliver telehealth services with low data usage.
- Community Leaders & Councils** – Oversee deployment and sustainability of mesh networks.
- Local IT Volunteers** – Assist in setup, troubleshooting, and maintenance.

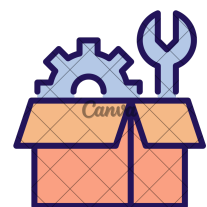
PROBLEMS TO SOLVE

- Inconsistent or non-existent internet in remote NT.
- High data costs making internet unaffordable.
- Education and telehealth access gaps for remote residents.



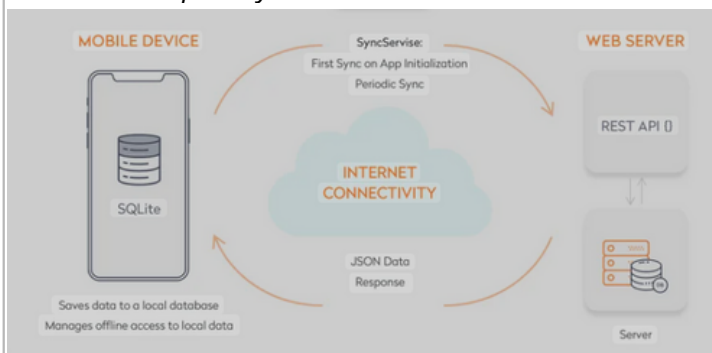
COMPONENTS

- Offline Learning App** – Educational content, quizzes, video playback, and auto-sync.
- Mesh Network Hardware** – Low-cost routers, Raspberry Pi nodes, and satellite uplink.
- Management Dashboard** – For network monitoring, bandwidth allocation, and troubleshooting.



FEATURES

- Works fully offline with sync-on-connect capability.



- Automatic mesh routing for uninterrupted local connectivity.



- Shared bandwidth among households to reduce costs.

MILESTONES



- Research & Planning – (2 weeks).
- Prototype Learning App – (4 weeks).
- Simulate Mesh Network – (2 weeks).
- Pilot Deployment – (6 weeks).
- Refinement & Expansion Plan – Incorporate feedback.

STAKEHOLDERS



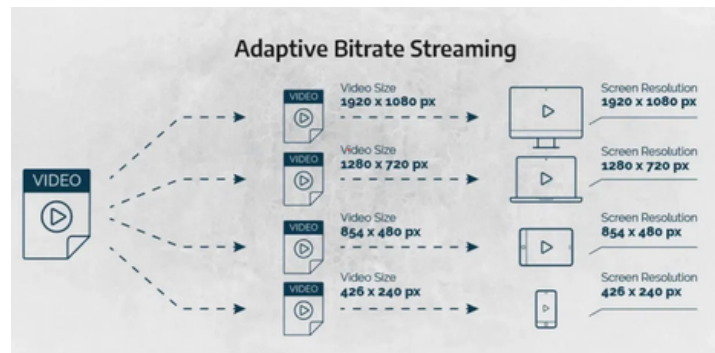
- NT Government Digital Strategy & Education Departments
- Community Councils
- Schools & Training Centres
- Healthcare Services
- Technology Partners

RISKS

- Difficulty sourcing affordable, durable hardware.
- Limited local technical expertise for maintenance.
- Weather and environmental challenges for outdoor equipment.
- Funding sustainability for long-term operations.



- Video compression and adaptive streaming to save bandwidth.



- Easy network setup with plug-and-play nodes.



DELIVERABLES



- Progressive Web App (PWA) or APK for learning platform.
- Mesh network simulation and hardware setup documentation.
- Poster and presentation for CDU IT Code Fair 2025.
- Community training materials.

APP NAME

LAST MILE NT



CONTEXT OF USAGE & COVERAGE

- Offline-first
- low-bandwidth, high-latency
- single satellite or cellular uplink

TECHNOLOGY

- Frontend: Flutter or React for PWA.
- Backend: Node.js with offline sync API.
- Network Simulation: NS-3 or Cisco Packet Tracer.

PLATFORM, OS, ...

- Android smartphones (primary).
- Web browsers (secondary).



ORIENTATION

Both portrait and landscape support



RELEASE

- local council partnership.
- Public r free app with open-source mesh network guidelines.